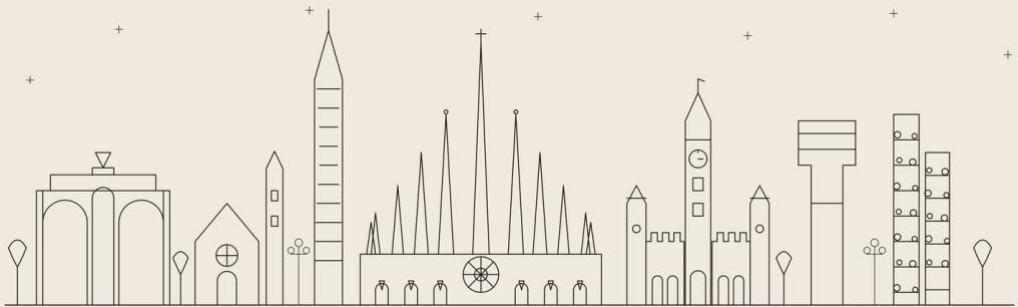


# HIDDEN CURATIONS

*A growing map of independent shops, curated by a local*

## YOUR ACCESS GUIDE



*The art of finding what others miss.*

## THE IDEA

Milano can feel overwhelming at first.

So many streets, so many stores — and very little indication of where to begin.

Hidden Milano was created to save you time. It brings together the places I would point out to a friend: addresses that are easy to miss, slightly off the proven path, and chosen because they are genuinely loved by locals.

*This guide leads you to where Milanese actually shop.*

This guide is intended to complement, not replace, Milano's well-known shopping streets. Areas such as Quadrilatero della Moda, Brera, Navigli or Corso Vittorio Emanuele and Corso Buenos Aires are already widely covered and easy to navigate.

This guide simply chooses to look beyond these — the quieter streets, independent boutiques, and local addresses that rarely make it into traditional guides. Hidden Milano exists to offer an alternative point of view.

Not logos on display, not trend-driven spaces, but stores defined by quality, discretion, and a sense of personal style. In Milano, elegance is rarely loud — it's thoughtful, restrained, and deeply individual.

Every place included here has been selected with care. These are shops where taste matters more than visibility, where craftsmanship and materials come before branding, and where the experience feels calm and considered.

Hidden Milano is meant to remove the guesswork, so you can spend less time searching and more time discovering — walking, wandering, and enjoying the city as it is lived.

I hope this guide feels like being quietly let in on something — a Milano that doesn't announce itself but stays with you.

*This is the Milano I know and love.*

## YOUR ACCESS

# How to Open Your Map

For quality control, your map lives on a private page rather than a public link — this keeps the guide exclusive to buyers and lets me keep it current without old, outdated copies circulating.

## YOUR MAP LINK

<https://hiddencurations.com/map-access>

## PASSWORD

milano2026

*This link and password refresh periodically as the map is updated — if a password ever stops working, reach out and I'll send the current one.*

## A note on sharing

Hidden Milano is licensed for your personal use. I'd rather you send a friend to [hiddencurations.com](https://hiddencurations.com) to get their own copy than pass along your access — it's a small endeavor, and every purchase directly funds the research and legwork that keeps new shops coming. I appreciate your understanding. *(Full terms at [hiddencurations.com/terms-of-service](https://hiddencurations.com/terms-of-service).)*

## GETTING STARTED

# How to Use This Guide

Hidden Milano is designed to be used as a companion, not a checklist. You won't find exhaustive lists or rigid itineraries here — just a way to explore naturally.

Use this guide to:

- Save time by going directly to carefully selected addresses
- Explore areas slightly off the proven path
- Discover where locals shop, rather than where visitors are usually directed

Each address has been chosen for its quality, character, and sense of discretion — some are best discovered spontaneously, others worth planning around. This guide is paired with a private, interactive map; I recommend bookmarking the page on your phone before heading out.

There is no right order and no need to see everything. Choose what resonates, return to what you love, and let the rest wait.

## INSIDE THE GUIDE

# What You've Got

Your purchase includes access to an interactive map featuring 400+ independent shops across Milano, organized into nine categories so you can browse by what you're looking for, rather than scrolling one long list.

- An interactive, pin-by-pin map — tap any shop for its name, a description, and directions
- Shops organized into nine browsable categories you can toggle on and off
- New shops added on an ongoing basis as the guide keeps growing
- This document, with tips on how to get the most out of the map while you're exploring

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## Opening & Navigating the Map

- Tap a category pill above the map to toggle it on or off — narrow things down to just what you're looking for
- Tap any pin for the shop's name, a short description, and two buttons: Directions (opens Google Maps navigation) and Open in Maps (for hours, reviews, and photos)
- Tap the small target icon in the top-left corner of the map to show your current location as you walk around
- Pinch to zoom into denser areas — shops cluster closely in certain neighborhoods
- Stores are listed in alphabetical order under each category so you can easily find them by name if needed

GOOD TO KNOW

The Categories

Every shop on the map falls into one of nine categories. Turn any of them on or off depending on what you're hunting for that day.

|                                     |                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Clothing & Accessories              | Independent boutiques and small labels — from tailored pieces to everyday wardrobe staples and accessories you won't find on the high street. |
| Vintage Shops                       | Secondhand and archive finds — curated racks, thrift gems, and specialist vintage dealers across the city.                                    |
| Home Decor                          | Objects, textiles, and design pieces for the home, sourced from small studios and family-run shops.                                           |
| Stationary, Books, Magazines & more | Paper goods, notebooks, independent bookshops, and specialist reading from Milano's stationery and book scene.                                |
| Jewelry                             | Fine and costume jewelry from independent makers and boutiques.                                                                               |
| Children                            | Clothing, toys, and gifts for children, from small, thoughtfully stocked shops.                                                               |
| Outlets                             | Discounted and past-season pieces from well-known or historic labels, for those who love a find.                                              |
| Mens                                | Independent menswear — tailoring, casual wear, and accessories.                                                                               |
| Beauty                              | Perfumeries, skincare, and beauty specialists with a curated, personal touch.                                                                 |

HELP IT GROW

Know a Hidden Gem?

This guide keeps growing because people who use it also tell me what I've missed. If there's a shop, atelier, or corner of Milano you think belongs here, I'd love to hear about it. Send the name and a line on what makes it worth including to [hello@hiddencurations.com](mailto:hello@hiddencurations.com). If it fits, it'll make it onto the map, and I'll let you know when it does.

## Neighborhoods at a Glance

You don't need a plan to use this map, but it helps to know roughly where things cluster. A short and rough orientation, not a route:

**Brera** — Cobblestone streets, small galleries, and boutique concept stores. Upscale but unpolished — Milano's most walkable shopping neighborhood. There are simply too many good addresses here to map them all – treat this as an invitation to wander block by block. Via Solferino, via Fiori Chiari, Corso Garibaldi... Brera is a must for shopping.

**Navigli** — Canal-side shops and design studios, busiest on weekends. Especially busy the last Sunday of each month due to the famous Antique Flea Market held along the Naviglio grande, when the market stalls come out along the water.

**Quadrilatero della Moda** — Milano's fashion quarter. The mecca for all high-end designer flagship stores, the names you probably already know. This guide skips these stores and points you to the small ateliers or niche brands tucked between them.

**Porta Venezia** — Eclectic and welcoming, with standout vintage and independent boutiques set against Liberty-era architecture.

**Magenta** — Elegant and understated, lined with 19th-century palazzos near the Last Supper and the Castello Sforzesco. Quieter than the fashion district, with refined boutiques, bookshops, and cafés tucked between the historic sights.

**Wagner** — A residential shopping area favored by locals over tourists, mixing well-known chains with independent boutiques. If you want to feel like you belong here, definitely check it out.

**Porta Romana** — South of the historic center, less touristy than Brera and more relaxed than Navigli. A genuinely lived-in neighborhood – home to the Fondazione Prada, small galleries, emerging designers and specialty food shops tucked between 19th century buildings and hidden gardens.

**Porta Ticinese** — Streetwear, vintage and a younger/alternative shopping scene, anchored around the Colonne di San Lorenzo.

**Porta Nuova** — More polished and design-forward (this is where Corso Como 10 lives). It's Milano's futuristic face – glass towers, Piazza Gae Aulenti and Bosco Verticale. Smaller boutiques tucked between skyscrapers and the aperitivo crowd.

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# Practical Notes

A few things worth knowing before you head out — the kind of thing that saves a wasted trip.

## Opening hours

Many independent shops close for a couple of hours at lunch (roughly 1–3:30pm) and don't open Monday mornings. Sunday hours vary widely — some shops close entirely. Make sure to check before heading there.

## August closures

Many independent shops close for part or all of August (definitely at *Ferragosto*). If you're visiting mid-summer, check a shop's Instagram or Google listing before making a special trip.

## Sales periods

Italy's sale windows (*saldi*) are set by regional law — typically early January and early July. If the Outlets category interests you, these windows are the best time to look.

## Cash vs. card

Most shops accept cards, but smaller boutiques and market stalls sometimes prefer cash. Worth carrying some, just in case.

## Tax-free shopping

Non-EU visitors can often claim a VAT refund on purchases over a minimum threshold. Ask the shop for a tax-free form at checkout and keep receipts until you've processed the refund at the airport. Please note that some of these smaller stores will not offer this service.

## A note on sizing

Italian sizing runs differently from US and UK. As a rough guide:

| IT / EU | UK | US |
|---------|----|----|
| 38      | 6  | 2  |
| 40      | 8  | 4  |
| 42      | 10 | 6  |
| 44      | 12 | 8  |
| 46      | 14 | 10 |

*Sizing varies by brand and era, especially in vintage — always try before you buy where you can.*

# About Me

Four years ago, after 20 years living in NYC and working for major fashion labels, I moved to Milano and was immediately struck by how stylish people here dress — not flashy, not branded necessarily, just a kind of taste and effortlessness that felt totally unforced. I wanted to find where locals actually shopped, and quickly realized the best places are often poorly advertised: the kind of shop you stumble into by accident or only find because someone takes you there.

I've been lucky to have friends who showed me around, and I've done plenty of digging on my own — but that takes time, and not everyone has it, especially if you are here visiting for a few days. So, I started asking myself: how do I put all of this down somewhere, and share it?

Hidden Milano is that answer — an ongoing project that keeps growing and changing right along with the city. I'm not a professional guide, a stylist, or an influencer, just someone who walks and bikes this city constantly and remembers the shops worth returning to.

This project is small, independent, and personal, and every shop on this map has been researched and chosen because it earned its place, not because it paid for it.

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## QUESTIONS, ANSWERED

### FAQ

#### **How often is the map updated?**

New shops are added on an ongoing basis as I find them. There's no fixed schedule — the map simply grows as the project does.

#### **Can I suggest a shop?**

Always. If there's a place you think belongs on this map, email me at [hello@hiddencurations.com](mailto:hello@hiddencurations.com) — the best additions usually come from people using the guide.

#### **What if a shop has closed or moved?**

Let me know and I'll update the map. Independent shops close and move more often than chains, and I'd rather hear it from you than leave a dead pin.

#### **Is this a one-time purchase?**

Yes — one purchase gives you ongoing access to the map, including future additions and updates, at no extra cost.

#### **Can I use this on all my devices?**

Yes. The map link works on your phone, tablet, or laptop — I'd recommend bookmarking it on your phone before you head out.

#### **My link or password isn't working. What do I do?**

Email [hello@hiddencurations.com](mailto:hello@hiddencurations.com) and I'll send the current access details straight away.

**@hiddencurations**  
**[www.hiddencurations.com](http://www.hiddencurations.com)**